

L2 - 1.2. SOC L2 Alert Triage

Task 1 - Introduction

In this room, you will learn the Level 2 workflow during alert triage and see how it differs from Level 1.

Task 2 - SOC L2 Workflow

Same as Level 1, you need a trigger to start your job. For L1, this trigger is a new alert. For L2, it's a reported incident: mostly in the form of an escalated SOC alert, but can also be a direct, urgent request from your management or MSSP customers.

Triage Aspect	Level 1	Level 2
Trigger	New security alert	Escalated alert
SLA	Applicable (MTTA/MTTR)	Applicable (Same as L1)
Focus	Quick alert triage within SLA	Deeper log analysis and response
Platform	Mostly a ticketing system and SIEM	Wider range of SOC and IT tools
Response	Basic response, such as: - Quarantine malicious download - Approve SOAR alert playbook	Advanced response, such as: - Manually clean up malware - Disable users and isolate hosts

Answer the questions below

| What is the most common trigger for L2 to start the triage?

Escalated Alert

Task 3 - Log Analysis as L2

1. Start the triage only once you understand the rule (know the technique the rule aims to detect)
2. Don't work on multiple cases at the same time (unless one is pending for the customer's action)

3. Aim to fit SLA. If the analysis takes too long, contain the threat and then continue investigating

Build Detailed Timelines

1. Filters for key Sysmon events from the NetDbg application
2. Highlights three indicators that may be useful in future triage(`lxdhk.dll` , `netupdate-pro.shop` , `159.89.143.156`)
3. Confirms that NetDbg is either compromised or a malware itself(A suspicious connection followed by DLL drop and execution)

Threat Hunting Loop

1. Form a story (hypothesis) from the alert details
2. Build a timeline of events to cover the gaps in the story
3. Think whether the story is now clear from start to finish
4. If not, return to step 1 and expand or change the story

Answer the questions below

| Should you understand the rule purpose before triaging the alert? (Yea/Nay)

Yea

| What term is used for a chronological list of events (related to the attack)?

Timeline

Task 4 - Threat Response

The response is where your and L1's work merge into a real action that stops the threat or prevents future threats. Every threat requires a response, but sometimes it is automatically applied by EDR or other security measures.

Verification of Activity:

- Ask IT to explain the purpose of an unfamiliar tool

- Consult IT support to confirm the creation of an administrator user
- Message DevOps to verify a suspicious API call coming from their script
- Reach out to the red team to distinguish a real intrusion from a pentest

Response to Major Incidents

1. **Containment:** Stop the threat from spreading by isolating hosts or disabling users
2. **Eradication:** Clean up malware files, rotate stolen passwords, revoke privileges, etc.
3. **Recovery:** Lift containment, patch the vulnerabilities, monitor for reinfection traces

Response to False Positives

Example	L2 Response	Often Called
The rule triggered on an unrelated system activity due to a flaw in its query	Plan a fix in the rule or report the issue to the engineering team	False Positive Tuning
The alert was a FP, but it highlighted a server with an Internet-exposed RDP	Cooperate with IT team to hide RDP access behind a VPN	Security Hardening
The alert was simple, but the L1 analysis was incomplete or incorrect	Explain the mistakes to L1 or plan a dedicated mentorship call	Team Improvement

Answer the questions below

What is the term for a temporary response that stops the threat from spreading?

Containment

You see a clearly malicious activity on one of the corporate devices. You also know about an ongoing pentest, but red teamers do not respond. Would you isolate the device before receiving a confirmation? (Yea/Nay)

Yea

Task 5 - Learning Lessons

Challenge: Open the static site by clicking the **View Site** button below. You will read the escalated alert and follow the triage workflow: analysis, response, and learning lessons from the incident. Once ready, grab your flag and answer the question.

Answer the questions below

| What is the flag you get at the end of the challenge?

THM{triage_done_right!}

Task 6 - Conclusion

SOC L2 alert triage goes far beyond log analysis. Communicating impact, responding to threats, tuning broken rules, and reflecting on outcomes are all core parts of the L2 workflow. The key takeaway: learn from your mistakes and take initiative to make your team better.